

German court see for themselves:

AUSCHWITZ REVISITED

The weather was appropriately cold and gloomy for the occasion. The ghosts of Auschwitz, twenty years after, are still not laid - probably never will be - and the members of the Frankfurt court who had come to the former Nazi camp to collect evidence seemed to be wrapped and muffled against more than the cold.

Twenty people are on trial in Frankfurt, charged with wartime atrocities. Certain facts had to be checked by the court - was it possible, for instance, for witnesses watching from certain huts to recognise the people who were selecting prisoners? - and the Polish authorities offered their full co-operation to the German court delegation. Distances were noted, measurements taken, and the grisly apparatus of crematoria and burial-sites were examined and photographed. Members of the group, raking the earth with their hands, pulled up the remains of bones and tufts of hair.

The court's activities had begun with a minute's silence at the 'Wall of Death', where Auschwitz victims once used to be shot by the SS. The judge, prosecuting and defence counsel, and court assistants then moved on to examine the extermination camp. With them was one of the twenty accused, former SS doctor  Lucas.

CAMERA PRESS (CAP) LONDON